

of the fastest-growing segments for us which is the vlogger community. And they're the ones who use smartphones very, very effectively. But there's a stage that comes in where they feel the need to upgrade to professional cameras for better video and audio quality and that is when they adopt our mirrorless range. For instance, the EOS M50 Mark II is the go-to model for all vloggers today because of its seamless recording features. So, when it comes to the future, there is no certain answer. However, you can surely expect the best from us, both from a technology point of view as well as from a consumer need point of view. While point and shoot at one stage did impact our business, today smartphones are only really complementing our business growth.

Q So you can say that smartphones provided that entry-level camera that everybody had in their pocket. So that's why the camera sales improved because of the improvements in smartphone cameras?

A I wouldn't say it that way. When you look at smartphones, obviously the reach is much deeper and that is why there has been an impact on our point-and-shoot systems. But interestingly, that same impact has now positively changed the consumer's mind. After a spending a certain amount of time using smartphones, consumers now look at upgrading to professional equipment especially content creators. And that's where we play a significant role in empowering such professionals. As a result of this, our mid and entry level segments have been performing very well.

Q Is something being done to make digital camera interfaces less daunting to new users, maybe some kind of software tweaks that are going to help transition people from smartphones to cameras better?

A Cameras today have very simple and seamless interfaces. With a tap of a button, one can create a quick video or click quality still images and in a second they are transferred to their smart devices or laptops. It's all very quick. So basically, the major reason why consumers upgrade to digital cameras

is because they need much more than what a smartphone is offering. In terms of the user interface, the UI has changed a lot and become very user-friendly. One can actually simply start with the intelligent auto mode, and simply click and shoot. The camera does all the calculations and settings on its own. Professional cameras provide much more control and flexibility. And that's where the Manual modes or the Program Modes come in. So the user interface is not complex at all. It's very, very intuitive, it's very smart and it's not complex at all.

Q People who have not been around cameras, but are very avid photographers on their smartphones, would still have a little bit of a learning curve to find their way around an entry-level camera today, even on auto...

A Yes, you are right, there is a learning curve. But that learning curve offers that flexibility and control to that user. We also do a lot of learning sessions for our consumers. There are a lot of online videos. We do a lot of webinars to help them adapt. But the value that it gives us is quite immense. At one stage the content creators need more, need better quality of sound, better quality of video. So the learning obviously comes with a lot of value in it.

Q Adding to the previous question, smartphones today employ a lot of computational photography. Are any kind of similar technologies going to be developed for interchangeable lens cameras as well?

A Yeah. So that's already there. Computational photography already exists in our interchangeable lens cameras. Auto mode already has all these.

Q But do you get a prompt saying that maybe a switch to this mode to get a better result or something like that?

A No. So there is only one auto mode which recognises the scene, whether it is a face, scenery, or any other environment, and based on the AI it appropriately changes the setting.

Q Can you give us an example of what is going on in the background

in terms of the software? So if I'm just taking a camera, putting it on auto mode, pointing it at something, it recognizes the scene... what is going on in its brain, basically?

A For example, if the camera recognizes a face, it identifies that we are about to take a photo or a portrait photo and changes the settings accordingly. Similarly, if it senses that it is scenery or landscape, it will change the settings appropriately for taking landscape photographs. Similarly, if it's one of our modern cameras like the EOS R3 or EOS R6 Mark II, it can even detect advanced subjects like animals, airplanes, trains and fast moving objects.

Q About enhancing the photo, should cameras add a filter and remove it? That is what a lot of smartphones do these days. Right?

A We don't do that. There are no filters on our cameras as of now. They are as close to reality as much as possible.

Q Would there be something like that in the future and would that make sense for camera manufacturers like Canon to add?

A For future products, we cannot comment now on the features but your suggestions are interesting.

Q What would be R6 Mk II headlining features? Like what is Canon very proud to have on the EOS R6 Mark II?

A It's really a true video device for entry-level content creators. Today, we have social media, OTT and an explosion of content creation. There is a huge number of, let's say, web series that are being created as well and a lot more documentaries that are coming out. The Canon EOS R6 Mark II is an answer to all of that. It's a perfect hybrid device for video professionals. You want video? Yes, available. You need still photography? Yes, available. So, it's a really strong device for entry-level professional videographers and then it also cuts across genres as well. The beauty of the EOS R6 Mark II is that at one end it caters to a content creator and on the other end, it caters to a wedding photographer or a wildlife photographer.